



SWAP Lower Volume Plan To Build Endurance and Speed

Note: the plan starts at 12-16 miles per week, building to 20-33 miles per week

Completing this plan will have you ready for most of our other plans!

	Mon	Tues	Wed	Thurs	Fri	Sat	Sun
Week 1	Rest. On rest days, aim to be active generally, but no pounding on your legs!	2-3 miles easy On easy runs, think light on feet and relaxed! Ideally aim for soft surfaces, and whatever terrain makes you happiest. You can always add some hiking to do more mileage as well! Keep it FUN--listen to silly playlists or podcasts, just viewing this as time for yourself to play. Intro Core Snack routine. Aim to do this routine 1-2 x per day most days ahead	1.5 miles easy warm-up, 6 x 30 second hills faster with jog down recovery, 1.5 miles easy cool-down On the hills, think smooth and strong, pushing hard by the top. These hill strides will improve your top-end power rapidly! Add single-leg step ups after the run, aiming for 30-50 reps on both legs! Something like yoga, pilates, or similar activities are amazing throughout the plan!	60-90 minute hike or cross train Hiking is just purposeful movement, ideally with some hills. Pump the arms and get moving! Cross training can be bike, elliptical, etc--ideally leg-strength building rather than upper body	2-3 miles easy Keep these runs very chill on Fridays. Remember: no pressure on pace!	4-6 miles easy/moderate Easy/moderate is not a specific effort, but just running with intention and purpose. You can add a few miles on these to complete a fun route if that sounds joyous! Hike as much as you need to for the mileage! Just try to run a few more steps than you usually would. Single-leg step-ups post-run!	1-2 hours hike or cross train You can go longer on these activities too, since they are non-impact! Athletes could add a 5th run to these weeks if feeling 100% healthy, just keep it easy!
Week 2	Rest. You can also add passive heat like sauna or hot tub any day!	2-3 miles easy plus 4 x 10 second hills faster On these short hills, you just want to practice building up to faster paces before the workout Wednesday!	1.5 miles easy warm-up, 4 x 1 min fast/2 min easy (think smooth and quick), 4 x 30 seconds fast/2 min easy (can push a bit more), 1.5 miles easy On these first flat intervals, relax your whole body and try to embrace the higher turnover rather than resisting it! Think "kid at recess" rather than "adult putting in work" Add single leg step-ups post-run	60-90 min hike or cross train On the hike or cross train ahead, you can push in an unstructured way, particularly on hills	2-3 miles easy	4-6 miles moderate Warm-up well and practice pushing this one just a bit more without going hard, getting comfortable with a bit more effort! Add single-leg step-ups	1-2 hours hike or cross train

Designed by David Roche & Megan Roche, MD PhD

[SWAP Running](#). [Some Work. All Play Podcast](#). You are AMAZING!

Week 3	Rest. Heat ideal	2-3 miles easy plus 4 x 20 second hills faster Now we are into classic hill stride territory, which will build speed and power!	1.5-2 miles easy warm-up, 8 x 1 min fast/90 seconds easy (think smooth and quick), 1.5-2 miles easy Slightly more volume on this session, but still manageable! Add single-leg step-ups	60-90 min hike or cross train	2-3 miles easy	6-8 miles easy Increasing the long run volume a bit, keeping this one very relaxed!	1-2 hours hike or cross train
Week 4	Rest. Heat ideal	3-4 miles easy The goal this week is to build aerobic volume! It'll operate as a down week from intensity, but building up the base!	4-6 miles moderate This type of run should start to get a bit more comfortable now! Add single-leg step ups. Aim to do 50 per leg now!	1-2 hours hike or cross train	2-3 miles easy	6-8 miles moderate For the workouts and moderate runs, it may be fun to have supershoes that make the effort feel better! Add single-leg step-ups	2-3 miles easy and/or 1-2 hours hike or x-train Adding an optional 5th day! In a perfect world, you do a short run followed by a hike or other activity!
Week 5	Rest. Heat ideal	3-4 miles easy plus 4 x 20 second hills faster Now we're bringing it all together with some intensity!	1.5-2 miles easy warm-up, 2 x 2 min fast with 2 min recovery, 3 x 1 min fast with 2 min recovery, 4 x 30 seconds fast with 2 min recovery, 1.5-2 miles easy cool-down Think 5k effort or easier on these intervals, practicing relaxed intensity. You can go harder on the 30 seconds if you are feeling good! Add single-leg step-ups	1-2 hours hike or x-train	2-3 miles easy	8-10 miles easy Keep this one very relaxed, just having fun with the distance as we build it up! Add single-leg step-ups	2-3 miles easy and/or 1-2 hours hike or x-train
Week 6	Rest. Heat ideal	4-6 miles easy Increasing the volume just a bit more!	1.5-2 miles easy warm-up, 6 x 1 minute hills mod/hard, 1.5-2 miles easy cool-down This session will help build up power! Add single-leg step-ups	1-2 hours hike or x-train	2-4 miles easy	8-10 miles moderate Keeping familiarity with the feeling of pushing a bit! Add single-leg step-ups	2-3 hours hike or x-train. Ideally a longer day after the quality long run! You can add a 5th run still, if that feels good, but ideally turn it into a longer hike or bike too
Week 7	Rest.	4-6 miles easy plus 4 x 20	1.5-2 miles easy warm-up, 1	1-2 hours hike or	2-4 miles	10-12 miles easy	2-3 hours hike or

Designed by David Roche & Megan Roche, MD PhD

[SWAP Running](#). [Some Work. All Play Podcast](#). You are AMAZING!

	Heat ideal	second hills faster	mile harder, 5 minutes easy, 4 x 30 seconds fast/2 min easy, 1.5-2 miles easy cool-down This quality mile is a great chance to check in on your progress! You can do it on a slight downhill if that sounds fun Add single-leg step-ups after	x-train	easy	Take this one very easy and push the distance a bit, whatever that means for you! Add single-leg step-ups	x-train. Another longer off-loading day! Same deal as last week on the 5th run plus hike/bike!
Week 8	Rest. Heat ideal	4-6 miles easy The goal this week is to get to your highest volume with health and joy!	6-8 miles moderate Add single-leg step-ups after	1-2 hours hike or x-train	2-4 miles easy	8-10 miles moderate Reflect on your growth from the first week of the plan!	3-5 miles easy and/or 1-2 hours hike or x-train Ideally add that 5th day of running if health is good!

After this plan, you should be confident to build into any of our other plans, starting at the low end of the mileage ranges

WE ARE SO PROUD OF YOU!!!!